

BIOGRAPHY (223 Words)

Bongani Mlambo is a Zimbabwean and South African cinematographer / director of photography & filmmaker based in Texas obsessed with telling stories visually, experimenting creatively, and exploring the world. In his free time he dances, he drums, and he ponders on social issues and the meaning of life.

Bongani's work has been praised for its "stunning artistry" and draws from influences such as Roger Deakins, Emmanuel Lubezki, Hoyt Van Hoytema, Rodrigo Prieto, and legends, Gordon Willis, Christopher Doyle, and Jordan Cronenweth to name a few. His most notable projects include "All Creatures" directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (The Dark Knight, Prisoners) and Karen Gillan (Guardians of the Galaxy, Dr. Who, Jumanji); "Three Days In August" directed by Johnathan Brownlee; "Upstream Color" directed by Shane Carruth; and "Woodshock" starring Kirsten Dunst.

Bongani got his start camera assisting on indie feature films, shooting short films & music videos, and then eventually adding commercials to his repertoire; narrative filmmaking holds his heart. In the future, Bongani wishes to work and excel as a director, director of photography, and producer - in his own words, "become a master, a legend, a virtuoso." Beyond his artistic pursuits, he is passionate about sharing his knowledge and talents and plans to establish an arts & film school in Zimbabwe, Africa, inspiring and helping more Zimbabweans and Africans to pursue visual and performing arts.

BIOGRAPHY (200 Words)

Bongani Mlambo is a Zimbabwean South African cinematographer & filmmaker based in Texas obsessed with telling stories visually, experimenting creatively, and exploring the world. In his free time, he dances, drums, and ponders on social issues and the meaning of life.

Bongani's work has been praised for its "stunning artistry" and draws from influences such as Roger Deakins, Emmanuel Lubezki, Hoyt Van Hoytema, and legends, Gordon Willis, Christopher Doyle, and Jordan Cronenweth to name a few. His notable projects include "All Creatures" directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (Dark Knight) and Karen Gillan (Guardians of the Galaxy, Dr. Who); "Three Days In August" directed by Johnathan Brownlee; "Upstream Color" by Shane Carruth; and "Woodshock" starring Kirsten Dunst.

Bongani got his start camera assisting on indie features, shooting short films, music videos, then eventually added commercials to his repertoire; Narrative filmmaking holds his heart. In the future, Bongani wishes to excel as a director, cinematographer, producer - in his own words, "become a master, a legend, a virtuoso." Beyond his artistic pursuits, he is passionate about sharing his knowledge and plans to establish an arts & film school in Zimbabwe, inspiring and helping more Zimbabweans and Africans to pursue visual and performing arts.

BIOGRAPHY Film Independent (Third Person) (100 Words)

Bongani Mlambo is a Zimbabwean South African cinematographer obsessed with telling visually creative and compelling stories.

Mlambo's work has been praised for its "stunning artistry" drawing from influences such as Roger Deakins, Emmanuel Lubezki, and Christopher Doyle. His recent projects include *All Creatures* directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (*Blade Runner 2049*, *The Dark Knight*) and Karen Gillan (*Guardians of the Galaxy*, *Jumanji*); *Three Days In August* by Johnathan Brownlee; *Upstream Color* by Shane Carruth; and *Woodshock* starring Kirsten Dunst.

Mlambo hopes to perfect his craft and sensibilities, one day, adding his name to the list of master artists.

BIOGRAPHY Film Independent (Third Person) (100 Words)(8/3/18)

Bongani Mlambo is a Zimbabwean South African cinematographer obsessed with telling visually creative and compelling stories.

Mlambo's recent projects include *All Creatures Here Below* directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (*Blade Runner 2049*, *The Dark Knight*) and Karen Gillan (*Guardians of the Galaxy*, *Jumanji*); *Three Days In August* by Johnathan Brownlee; *Upstream Color* by Shane Carruth; and *Woodshock* starring Kirsten Dunst. His work has won awards at SXSW, the NBCUniversal Short Film Festival, Tellys, and numerous other festivals.

Beyond his artistic pursuits, Mlambo loves to dance, drum, and ponder on social issues and the meaning of life.

Bongani Mlambo is a Zimbabwean South African cinematographer based in LA and obsessed with telling visually creative and compelling stories.

Bongani's recent projects include *All Creatures* directed by Collin Schiffli; *Three Days In August* by Johnathan Brownlee; *Woodshock* starring Kirsten Dunst; and commercials and shorts. His work has

won awards at the NBCU Short Film Festival, SXSW, Telly's, and numerous others. He is a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow and recipient of the 2019 ICG Emerging Cinematographer Award.

Beyond his artistic pursuits, Bongani loves to dance, drum, and ponder on social issues and the meaning of life.

BIOGRAPHY WEBSITE

Bongani Mlambo, aka Bongaj, is a Zimbabwean South African cinematographer / director of photography & filmmaker obsessed with telling visually creative and compelling stories and exploring the world.

Bongani's work has been praised for its "stunning artistry" drawing from influences such as Roger Deakins, Emmanuel Lubezki, Hoyt Van Hoytema, Rodrigo Prieto, and legends, Gordon Willis, Christopher Doyle, and Jordan Cronenweth to name a few. His recent projects include *All Creatures* directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (Blade Runner 2049, The Dark Knight) and Karen Gillan (Guardians of the Galaxy, Jumanji); *Three Days In August* by Johnathan Brownlee; *Upstream Color* by Shane Carruth; and *Woodshock* starring Kirsten Dunst.

Beyond his artistic pursuits, Bongani loves to dance, drum, and ponder on social issues and the meaning of life. He is passionate about sharing his knowledge and talents and plans to establish an arts & film school in Zimbabwe, inspiring and helping the next generation of Africans to pursue their dreams in the visual and performing arts.

Cameras:

Arri Alexa Mini (w/Open Gate, 4:3, Arriraw, batteries, cards, shoulder rig, et al)

Lenses:

Leica-R Set (19mm f2.8, 24mm f2.8, 35mm f2, 50mm f2, 90mm f2.8, 135mm f2.8)

AKS:

Ready Rig, Backstage Camera Cart, Atomos Shogun, Hazer, et cetera

Local 600: Roster | Central | Los Angeles

Contact:

bongani@bongaj.com

214-886-0288

[IMDB](#)

BIOGRAPHY Website (Updated 8/3/18)

Bongani Mlambo is a Zimbabwean South African cinematographer based in Los Angeles obsessed with telling visually creative and compelling stories and exploring the world.

Bongani's recent projects include *All Creatures* directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (*Blade Runner 2049*, *The Dark Knight*) and Karen Gillan (*Guardians of the Galaxy*, *Jumanji*); *Three Days In August* by Johnathan Brownlee; *Upstream Color* by Shane Carruth; and *Woodshock* starring Kirsten Dunst. His work has won awards at the NBC Universal Short Film Festival, SXSW, and numerous other festivals and he is a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow and recipient of the 2019 ICG Emerging Cinematographer Award.

Beyond his artistic pursuits, Bongani loves to dance, drum, and ponder on social issues and the meaning of life. He is passionate about sharing his knowledge and talents and plans to establish an arts & film school in Zimbabwe, inspiring and helping the next generation of Africans to pursue their dreams in the visual and performing arts.

BIOGRAPHY Website (Updated 9/28/21)

Bongani Mlambo is a Zimbabwean South African cinematographer based in Los Angeles obsessed with telling visually creative and compelling stories and exploring the world.

Bongani's recent projects include *All Creatures* directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (Blade Runner 2049, The Dark Knight) and Karen Gillan (Guardians of the Galaxy, Jumanji); *Three Days In August* by Johnathan Brownlee; *Upstream Color* by Shane Carruth; and *Woodshock* starring Kirsten Dunst. His work has screened and won awards at the NBC Universal Short Film Festival, SXSW, Hollyshorts, Fantastic Fest, and numerous other festivals and he is a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow and recipient of the 2019 ICG Emerging Cinematographer Award.

Bongani's recent projects include features *We're All Gonna Die* by Rocketjump duo Freddie Wong and Matt Arnold; *All Creatures* directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (Suicide Squad, Blade Runner 2049, The Dark Knight) and Karen Gillan (Guardians of the Galaxy, Jumanji); *Three Days In August* by Johnathan Brownlee; *Upstream Color* by Shane Carruth; and numerous commercials, shorts, music videos, and some television. His work has won awards at the NBC Universal Short Film Festival, SXSW, and numerous other festivals; he is a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow; and recipient of the 2019 ICG Emerging Cinematographer Award.

Beyond his artistic pursuits, Bongani loves to dance, drum, and ponder on social issues and the meaning of life. He is passionate about sharing his knowledge and talents and plans to establish an arts & film school in Zimbabwe, inspiring and helping the next generation of Africans to pursue their dreams in the visual and performing arts.

Biography - Website - 10.4.22 updated

Bongani Mlambo is a cinematographer based in Los Angeles, California. He grew up in Harare, Zimbabwe, an introspective child whose imagination blossomed into a curiosity and quest for truth and meaning that have defined his life and art.

Bongani loves to tell visually creative and compelling stories that are meaningful and authentic and seeks to blur the lines between memories, experiences, perspectives, and imagination. He is a storyteller above all else, applying his artistic sensibilities and attention to detail to narrative projects and commercials, moving seamlessly between both worlds.

His recent projects include features, ***We're All Gonna Die*** by Rocketjump duo Freddie Wong and Matt Arnold; ***All Creatures*** directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (Suicide Squad, Blade Runner 2049, The Dark Knight) and Karen Gillan (Guardians of the Galaxy, Jumanji, Dr Who); ***The Virgin of Highland Park*** by Sonia Sebastian, starring Penelope Ann Miller and Dermot Mulroney; ***Three Days In August*** by Johnathan Brownlee; and ***Upstream Color*** by Shane Carruth.

More recently, Bongani's credits also include ***The Hair Tales*** TV series by Tracee Ellis Ross and Michaela Angela Davis for OWN, Onyx Collective, and Hulu; ***Waffles and Mochi Holiday Feast*** special for Netflix and the Obama's Higher Ground production company; and ***Dot and Brie Talk TV*** on Hulu.

He has also photographed numerous commercials, short films, music videos, and television, working with talent such as Oprah Winfrey, Tracee Ellis Ross, Issa Rae, Marsai Martin, Chloe Bailey, Chika, Morgan Freeman, Constance Wu, Anthony Mackie, Helen Mirren, Serena Williams, Blue October, Jabari Banks, Jamie-Lynn Sigler, Jasmine Cephas Jones, Lance Gross, Diarra Kilpatrick, Sherman Augustus, Prema Cruz, Kirsten Dunst, and Samin Nusrat.

He has collaborated with brands such as Dove, State Farm, Hasbro, Instagram, BET, Adidas, Lexus, Buick, JCPenney, Goodyear, Mary Kay, Nike, Southwest Airlines, Gearbox, Ubisoft, Ford, Mazda, Peacock, Everlane, Kinly, Midwest Bank, and Google Quantum.

Bongani's work as director of photography has screened and won awards at South By Southwest (SXSW), The International Cinematographer's Guild Emerging Cinematographer Awards, The Tellys, the NBCUniversal Short Film Festival, Cannes International Series Festival,

Fantastic Fest, Cucalorus, Idyllwild, Hollyshorts, Urbanworld Film Festival, LA Shorts Fest and numerous others.

He is also a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow and has supported and collaborated with filmmakers in Disney Launchpad, WarnerMedia OneFifty, Netflix Emerging Filmmaker Initiative, Film Independent's Global Media Makers, and Hulu's Bite Size Halloween. Bongani is an advocate for and believes in diversity and inclusion in front of and behind the lens.

Beyond his filmmaking pursuits, Bongani loves to dance, drum, dj, play tennis, and ponder on social issues and the meaning of life. He is passionate about sharing his knowledge and talents and plans to establish arts & film workshops, programs, and residencies in Zimbabwe, with the intention of guiding and inspiring the next generation of Africans to tell stories and pursue their dreams in the visual and performing arts.

Potential Short Versions:

A

Bongani Mlambo is Zimbabwean-born cinematographer based in Los Angeles, California. He loves to tell authentic, compelling and visually creative stories, and is able to move seamlessly between commercial and narrative worlds. His most recent work includes: ***We're All Gonna Die*** by Rocketjump duo Freddie Wong and Matt Arnold which premiered at SXSW 2024; ***The Hair Tales*** TV series by Tracee Ellis Ross and Michaela Angela Davis for OWN, Onyx Collective, and Hulu; ***Waffles and Mochi Holiday Feast*** special for Netflix and the Obama's Higher Ground production company; and ***Dot and Brie Talk TV*** on Hulu. He is a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow and has collaborated with filmmakers in Disney Launchpad, WarnerMedia OneFifty, Netflix Emerging Filmmaker Initiative, Film Independent's Global Media Makers, Hulu's Bite Size Halloween. Bongani supports and believes in diversity and inclusion in front of and behind the lens.

B.

Bongani Mlambo is Zimbabwean-born cinematographer based in Los Angeles, California. A 2018 Project Involve Fellow, and a 2019 recipient of the Emerging Cinematographer awards his commercial and narrative work have been featured on Netflix, Hulu, and Peacock. Additionally, Bongani's work as director of photography has won awards at South By Southwest (SXSW), The Tellys, the NBCUniversal Short Film Festival, and numerous other festivals. Most recently, he completed: ***The Hair Tales*** TV series by Tracee Ellis and Michaela Angela Davis for OWN.

C.

Bongani Mlambo is a multi-award winning Zimbabwean-born cinematographer based in Los Angeles, California. His commercial and narrative work can be found across various networks and platforms including: Hulu, OWN, Netflix, Peacock, & Disney+.

Biography - Enhanced

Biography - Website - Updated Sept 2024

Bongani Mlambo is a visionary cinematographer based in Los Angeles, California. He grew up in Harare, Zimbabwe, an introspective child whose imagination blossomed into a curiosity and quest for truth and meaning that have defined his life and art. This unique background has shaped his perspective, allowing him to bring a fresh, global viewpoint to his work in the American film industry.

Bongani loves to tell visually creative and compelling stories that are meaningful and authentic, seeking to blur the lines between memories, experiences, perspectives, and imagination. He is a storyteller above all else, applying his artistic sensibilities and attention to detail to narrative projects and commercials, moving seamlessly between both worlds. His ability to craft unique visual languages for each project, from gritty realism to heightened stylization, sets him apart in the industry.

His recent projects include features such as "We're All Gonna Die" by Rocketjump duo Freddie Wong and Matt Arnold, which was an official selection at SXSW 2024; "All Creatures" directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (Suicide Squad, Blade Runner 2049, The Dark Knight) and Karen Gillan (Guardians of the Galaxy, Jumanji, Dr Who); "The Virgin of Highland Park" by Sonia Sebastian, starring Penelope Ann Miller and Dermot Mulroney; "Three Days In August" by Johnathan Brownlee; and "Upstream Color" by Shane Carruth. These diverse projects showcase Bongani's versatility and his ability to adapt to various genres and visual styles.

More recently, Bongani's credits have expanded to include high-profile television series, demonstrating his readiness for larger-scale productions. His work includes "The Hair Tales" TV series by Tracee Ellis Ross and Michaela Angela Davis for OWN, Onyx Collective, and Hulu; "Waffles and Mochi Holiday Feast" special for Netflix and the Obama's Higher Ground production company; and "Dot and Brie Talk TV" on Hulu. These projects highlight Bongani's ability to handle the demands of network and streaming productions while maintaining his unique artistic vision.

He has also photographed numerous commercials, short films, music videos, and television shows, working with an impressive array of talent such as Oprah Winfrey, Tracee Ellis Ross, Issa Rae, Marsai Martin, Chloe Bailey, Chika, Morgan Freeman, Constance Wu, Anthony Mackie, Helen Mirren, Serena Williams, Blue October, Jabari Banks, Jamie-Lynn Sigler, Jasmine Cephas Jones, Lance Gross, Diarra Kilpatrick, Sherman Augustus, Prema Cruz, Kirsten Dunst, and Samin Nusrat. This extensive list of collaborations speaks to Bongani's professionalism and ability to work effectively with high-profile talent.

Bongani's commercial work is equally impressive, having collaborated with major brands such as Dove, State Farm, Hasbro, Instagram, BET, Adidas, Lexus, Buick, JCPenney, Goodyear, Mary Kay, Nike, Southwest Airlines, Gearbox, Ubisoft, Ford, Mazda, Peacock, Everlane, Kinly, Midwest Bank, and Google Quantum. His experience across various project types and scales demonstrates his versatility and consistent ability to deliver high-quality work.

Bongani's talent has not gone unnoticed in the industry. His work as director of photography has screened and won awards at prestigious festivals and competitions, including South By Southwest (SXSW), The International Cinematographer's Guild Emerging Cinematographer Awards, The Tellys, the NBCUniversal Short Film Festival, Cannes International Series Festival, Fantastic Fest, Cucalorus, Idyllwild, Hollyshorts, Urbanworld Film Festival, LA Shorts Fest and numerous others. These accolades serve as a testament to his exceptional skills and the impact of his work.

As a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow, Bongani has consistently demonstrated his commitment to the film community and to fostering new talent. He has supported and collaborated with filmmakers in various initiatives, including Disney Launchpad, WarnerMedia OneFifty, Netflix Emerging Filmmaker Initiative, Film Independent's Global Media Makers, and Hulu's Bite Size Halloween. Bongani is a passionate advocate for diversity and inclusion in front of and behind the lens, using his platform to create opportunities for underrepresented voices in the industry.

Beyond his filmmaking pursuits, Bongani is a multifaceted individual with a wide range of interests. He loves to dance, drum, DJ, play tennis, and ponder social issues and the meaning of life. These diverse passions inform his work, contributing to the depth and authenticity of his visual storytelling.

Bongani's journey from Zimbabwe to Hollywood exemplifies his extraordinary determination and talent. He is passionate about sharing his knowledge and experience, with plans to establish arts & film workshops, programs, and residencies in Zimbabwe. His goal is to guide and inspire the next generation of African storytellers, encouraging them to pursue their dreams in the visual and performing arts.

With his unique background, technical mastery, and artistic vision, Bongani Mlambo continues to push the boundaries of visual storytelling. His work not only captures the eye but also touches the heart, making him a sought-after collaborator for filmmakers seeking to create truly impactful and memorable cinematic experiences.

Biography - Reimagined

Bongani Mlambo: Visionary Cinematographer, Global Storyteller

From the vibrant streets of Harare, Zimbabwe to the bustling film sets of Hollywood, Bongani Mlambo's journey as a cinematographer is a testament to the power of imagination, perseverance, and the universal language of visual storytelling.

Born with an introspective nature and a boundless curiosity, Bongani's childhood in Zimbabwe laid the foundation for a unique perspective that would later define his artistic voice. This early quest for truth and meaning, nurtured in a country without a robust film industry, has blossomed into a distinctive approach to cinematography that seamlessly blends cultural insights with technical mastery.

Bongani's rise in the competitive world of Hollywood cinematography has been nothing short of meteoric. In just over a decade, he has progressed from a budding camera assistant to an award-winning Director of Photography, leaving an indelible mark on projects across the spectrum of the entertainment industry.

His feature film work showcases a remarkable versatility, from the indie darling "We're All Gonna Die" (SXSW 2024 selection) to the star-studded "All Creatures" featuring Karen Gillan and David Dastmalchian. Bongani's ability to craft unique visual languages for each project has made him a go-to collaborator for directors seeking to push creative boundaries.

Television has provided another canvas for Bongani's artistry. His work on "The Hair Tales" (OWN/Hulu) and "Waffles and Mochi Holiday Feast" (Netflix/Higher Ground) demonstrates his readiness to handle high-pressure, high-budget productions while maintaining his signature style. These projects, along with numerous commercials for brands like Dove, Google, and Nike, highlight Bongani's adaptability and his knack for creating visually stunning content across various formats.

What sets Bongani apart is not just his technical prowess, but his philosophy towards filmmaking. He approaches each project as an opportunity to blur the lines between memories, experiences, perspectives, and imagination. This unique viewpoint, combined with his meticulous attention to detail, allows him to create immersive visual worlds that resonate deeply with audiences.

Bongani's talent has not gone unnoticed by the industry. He is a recipient of the prestigious Emerging Cinematographer Award from the International Cinematographers Guild and his work has been celebrated at festivals worldwide, including SXSW, Cannes Series, and the

NBCUniversal Short Film Festival. As a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow, he continues to pay it forward, actively supporting initiatives that promote diversity and inclusion in the film industry.

Collaboration is at the heart of Bongani's approach. He has worked with a constellation of stars including Oprah Winfrey, Morgan Freeman, and Helen Mirren, earning a reputation not just for his visual acumen but for his ability to create a calm, focused atmosphere on set. This "calming aura," as noted by many collaborators, makes him an invaluable asset on high-stakes productions.

Beyond the lens, Bongani is a renaissance man whose interests inform and enrich his work. A lover of dance, music, and philosophical discourse, he brings a holistic understanding of rhythm, movement, and human nature to his cinematography. This multifaceted background allows him to approach each project with a fresh perspective, finding innovative ways to serve the story through visuals.

Looking to the future, Bongani is not content to rest on his laurels. He is passionate about nurturing the next generation of storytellers, particularly in Africa. His plans to establish arts and film workshops in Zimbabwe speak to his commitment to opening doors and creating opportunities, just as he has done throughout his career.

Bongani Mlambo stands at the forefront of a new generation of cinematographers who are redefining the boundaries of visual storytelling. With his unique blend of technical expertise, artistic vision, and global perspective, he is not just capturing images – he's capturing imaginations. For filmmakers seeking a collaborator who can elevate their project from the ordinary to the extraordinary, Bongani Mlambo is more than a cinematographer. He's a visual alchemist, turning stories into gold, one frame at a time.

</reimagined_biography>

Biography - Short - Enhanced x Reimagined

Enhanced Biography Versions:

140 words:

Bongani Mlambo, a visionary cinematographer based in Los Angeles, hails from Harare, Zimbabwe. His introspective nature and quest for meaning define his artistic approach, blurring lines between memories, experiences, and imagination. Bongani's work spans award-winning features like "We're All Gonna Die" (SXSW 2024) and TV series such as "The Hair Tales" (OWN/Hulu). He's collaborated with A-list talent and major brands, earning recognition at SXSW, Cannes, and the International Cinematographer's Guild. A 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow, Bongani advocates for diversity in film. He's supported initiatives like Disney Launchpad and Netflix Emerging Filmmaker Initiative. Beyond filmmaking, he enjoys dance, music, and pondering life's meaning. Bongani plans to establish arts workshops in Zimbabwe, inspiring the next generation of African storytellers.

90 words:

Bongani Mlambo, a Los Angeles-based cinematographer from Zimbabwe, crafts visually compelling stories across features, TV, and commercials. His work, including "We're All Gonna Die" (SXSW 2024) and "The Hair Tales" (OWN/Hulu), has garnered awards and collaborations with major talents and brands. A 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow, Bongani champions diversity in film. He's supported initiatives like Disney Launchpad and plans to establish arts workshops in Zimbabwe. His unique background and multifaceted interests in dance, music, and philosophy enrich his visual storytelling approach.

40 words:

Bongani Mlambo, a Zimbabwean-born cinematographer in LA, creates award-winning visuals for features, TV, and commercials. His work, seen at SXSW and on major networks, reflects his unique global perspective. Bongani advocates for diversity and nurtures emerging filmmakers, especially in Africa.

Reimagined Biography Versions:

140 words:

Bongani Mlambo's journey from Harare to Hollywood embodies the power of visual storytelling. This award-winning cinematographer blends his Zimbabwean roots with technical mastery, creating immersive worlds across features, TV, and commercials. His work on "We're All Gonna Die" (SXSW 2024) and "The Hair Tales" (OWN/Hulu) showcases his versatility and artistic vision. Bongani's unique approach, blurring lines between memory and imagination, has earned him collaborations with stars like Oprah Winfrey and brands such as Google. Recognized with the Emerging Cinematographer Award, he's known for his calming on-set presence and innovative visual solutions. A champion for diversity, Bongani actively supports emerging filmmakers. His multifaceted interests in dance, music, and philosophy enrich his work, as he continues to redefine visual storytelling and inspire the next generation of African filmmakers.

90 words:

Bongani Mlambo, a visionary cinematographer, translates his Zimbabwean perspective into compelling visuals for Hollywood. His work, from SXSW-selected features to high-profile TV series, demonstrates versatility and artistic depth. Collaborating with stars and major brands, Bongani's known for creating immersive visual worlds and a calming on-set presence. An Emerging Cinematographer Award recipient, he champions diversity in film. Bongani's interests in dance, music, and philosophy enrich his storytelling approach. He's committed to nurturing new talent, especially in Africa, aiming to inspire the next generation of visual storytellers.

40 words:

Bongani Mlambo, award-winning cinematographer, brings Zimbabwean perspective to Hollywood storytelling. His work spans features, TV, and commercials, earning accolades and A-list collaborations. Known for immersive visuals and on-set calm, Bongani champions diversity and nurtures emerging African filmmakers.

Biography - Reimagined v2

Bongani Mlambo: Visionary Cinematographer, Global Storyteller

From the vibrant streets of Harare, Zimbabwe to the bustling film sets of Hollywood, Bongani Mlambo's journey as a cinematographer is a testament to the power of imagination and perseverance. Born with an introspective nature and boundless curiosity, Bongani's unique perspective has fueled a meteoric rise in the competitive world of cinematography. In just over a decade, he has progressed from a budding camera assistant to an award-winning Director of Photography, leaving an indelible mark on projects across the entertainment industry.

Bongani's feature film work showcases a remarkable versatility, from the indie darling "We're All Gonna Die" (SXSW 2024 selection) to the star-studded "All Creatures" featuring Karen Gillan and David Dastmalchian. His ability to craft unique visual languages for each project has made him a go-to collaborator for directors seeking to push creative boundaries. In television, his work on "The Hair Tales" (OWN/Hulu) and "Waffles and Mochi Holiday Feast" (Netflix/Higher Ground) demonstrates his readiness to handle high-pressure, high-budget productions while maintaining his signature style. These projects, along with numerous commercials for brands like Dove, Google, and Nike, highlight Bongani's adaptability and his knack for creating visually stunning content across various formats.

What sets Bongani apart is not just his technical prowess, but his philosophy towards filmmaking. He approaches each project as an opportunity to blur the lines between memories, experiences, perspectives, and imagination. This unique viewpoint, combined with his meticulous attention to detail, allows him to create immersive visual worlds that resonate deeply with audiences.

Bongani's talent has not gone unnoticed by the industry. He is a recipient of the prestigious Emerging Cinematographer Award from the International Cinematographers Guild and his work has been celebrated at festivals worldwide, including SXSW, Cannes Series, and the NBCUniversal Short Film Festival. As a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow, he continues to pay it forward, actively supporting initiatives that promote diversity and inclusion in the film industry.

Collaboration is at the heart of Bongani's approach. He has worked with a constellation of stars including Oprah Winfrey, Morgan Freeman, and Helen Mirren, earning a reputation not just for his visual acumen but for his ability to create a calm, focused atmosphere on set. This "calming aura," as noted by many collaborators, makes him an invaluable asset on high-stakes productions.

Beyond the lens, Bongani is a renaissance man whose interests inform and enrich his work. A lover of dance, music, and philosophical discourse, he brings a holistic understanding of rhythm, movement, and human nature to his cinematography. This multifaceted background allows him to approach each project with a fresh perspective, finding innovative ways to serve the story through visuals.

Looking to the future, Bongani is not content to rest on his laurels. He is passionate about nurturing the next generation of storytellers, particularly in Africa. His plans to establish arts and film workshops in Zimbabwe speak to his commitment to opening doors and creating opportunities, just as he has done throughout his career.

Bongani Mlambo stands at the forefront of a new generation of cinematographers who are redefining the boundaries of visual storytelling. With his unique blend of technical expertise, artistic vision, and global perspective, he is not just capturing images – he's capturing imaginations. For filmmakers seeking a collaborator who can elevate their project from the ordinary to the extraordinary, Bongani Mlambo is more than a cinematographer. He's a visual alchemist, turning stories into gold, one frame at a time.

</reimagined_biography>

Now, here are the three shorter versions of this new long version:

<response>

140 words:

Bongani Mlambo, a visionary cinematographer from Zimbabwe, has rapidly ascended in Hollywood, crafting unique visual languages across features, TV, and commercials. His work, including "We're All Gonna Die" (SXSW 2024) and "The Hair Tales" (OWN/Hulu), showcases his versatility and artistic vision. Bongani's approach blurs lines between memories and imagination, creating immersive worlds that resonate with audiences. An Emerging Cinematographer Award recipient, he's known for his calming on-set presence and collaborations with stars like Oprah Winfrey. Beyond his technical prowess, Bongani's interests in dance, music, and philosophy enrich his storytelling. A champion for diversity, he actively supports emerging filmmakers, especially in Africa. Bongani Mlambo stands as a visual alchemist, elevating projects from ordinary to extraordinary with his unique global perspective.

90 words:

Bongani Mlambo, a Zimbabwean-born cinematographer, brings a unique global perspective to Hollywood. His versatile work spans award-winning features, TV series, and major brand commercials, earning accolades and high-profile collaborations. Bongani's approach, blending memories and imagination, creates immersive visual worlds. Known for his technical expertise and calming on-set presence, he's a sought-after collaborator. His interests in dance, music, and philosophy enrich his visual storytelling. A champion for diversity, Bongani actively supports

emerging filmmakers, especially in Africa, aiming to redefine the boundaries of visual storytelling.

40 words:

Bongani Mlambo, award-winning cinematographer from Zimbabwe, crafts immersive visuals across film, TV, and commercials. Known for his unique perspective, technical prowess, and on-set calm, he collaborates with top talent. Bongani champions diversity and nurtures emerging filmmakers, redefining visual storytelling boundaries.

Biography - LinkedIn Enhanced

Bongani Mlambo is a visionary cinematographer based in Los Angeles, California. His upbringing in Harare, Zimbabwe, instilled a profound curiosity, introspection, and a quest for truth and meaning that deeply inform his art. This unique background allows him to bring a fresh perspectives.

Bongani excels at crafting visually captivating and compelling stories that resonate with audiences on an emotional level. He seamlessly blends memories, experiences, perspectives, and imagination, blurring the lines between reality and the surreal. As a storyteller at heart, he applies his artistic sensibilities and meticulous attention to detail to both narrative projects and commercials, moving effortlessly between both worlds.

His portfolio includes feature films such as "We're All Gonna Die," an official selection at SXSW 2024; "All Creatures," starring David Dastmalchian and Karen Gillan; Three Days In August, by Johnathan Brownlee; and Shane Carruth's critically acclaimed "Upstream Color." Bongani's television credits include the impactful series "The Hair Tales" for OWN and Hulu, as well as Netflix's "Waffles and Mochi Holiday Feast" produced by the Obamas' Higher Ground.

Bongani has collaborated with a diverse array of acclaimed talent, including Oprah Winfrey, Tracee Ellis Ross, Issa Rae, Morgan Freeman, Helen Mirren, and Serena Williams, Chloe Bailey, Blue October, and others. His commercial work boasts collaborations with major brands like Dove, State Farm, Adidas, Nike, BET, Lexus, Ubisoft, Mazda, Google Quantum, to name a few, demonstrating his versatility and ability to deliver high-quality work across various platforms.

His talent has been recognized at prestigious festivals and competitions, including SXSW, the International Cinematographer's Guild Emerging Cinematographer Awards, The Tellys, and Cannes International Series Festival. As a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow, Bongani is deeply committed to fostering new talent and promoting diversity and inclusion in the film industry.

Beyond filmmaking, Bongani's passions include tennis, dancing, drumming, DJing, and contemplating social issues. He is dedicated to giving back to his community and plans to establish arts and film programs in Zimbabwe and South Africa to inspire future generations of African storytellers.

With his unique background, technical mastery, and unwavering artistic vision, Bongani Mlambo continues to push the boundaries of visual storytelling, creating impactful and memorable cinematic experiences that resonate with audiences worldwide.

Bongani Inc Linked In

Tagline - "Crafting immersive visual narratives, blending global perspectives and elevating stories through innovation and artistry"

Bongani Inc., led by cinematographer Bongani Mlambo, is dedicated to elevating visual storytelling through innovative cinematography and creative development.

Bongani brings his unique perspective, honed from his Zimbabwean roots and global experiences, to every project. He excels at crafting visually captivating stories that blur the lines between reality and the surreal, seamlessly moving between narrative and commercial worlds. His work is characterized by a meticulous attention to detail and a commitment to authenticity, always striving to serve the story's emotional core.

With a portfolio spanning award-winning features, high-profile TV series, and major brand commercials, Bongani has collaborated with acclaimed talent and brands worldwide. His work has been recognized at prestigious festivals including SXSW, Cannes International Series Festival, and the International Cinematographer's Guild Emerging Cinematographer Awards.

Looking to the future, Bongani Inc. aims to expand its services to include:

Story Consultation: Leveraging Bongani's storytelling expertise to help shape compelling narratives from concept to screen.

Cinematography Consultations: Offering guidance to emerging and established filmmakers on visual strategy and technical execution.

Production and Creative Executive Services: Developing and packaging projects with a focus on unique voices and innovative storytelling.

Beyond our current services, Bongani Inc. is committed to nurturing the next generation of filmmakers, particularly in Zimbabwe and across Africa. We envision creating educational programs, workshops, and resources to empower emerging talent and elevate the quality and prestige of African cinema on the global stage.

We believe in the transformative power of visual storytelling and are dedicated to pushing the boundaries of the art form and creating impactful, memorable cinematic experiences that resonate with audiences worldwide.

BIO (Ad 2Dallas, 550 characters)

Bongani Mlambo is a Zimbabwean South African cinematographer obsessed with telling visually creative and compelling stories. His work has been praised for its “stunning artistry” drawing from influences such as Roger Deakins, Emmanuel Lubezki, and Christopher Doyle. His recent narrative projects include All Creatures directed by Collin Schiffli; Three Days In August by Johnathan Brownlee; Upstream Color by Shane Carruth; and Woodshock starring Kirsten Dunst. Between films, Bongani is busy on commercials, short films, and music videos.

Instagram

Cinematographer / DP / Filmmaker: features commercials music videos. #ProjectInvolve Fellow. Shot #allcreaturesherebelow #upstreamcolor. 📷 #alexamini

Vimeo

Cinematographer / DP, Camera operator, Filmmaker. #UPSTREAMCOLOR. #allCreatures. #woodshock. Features Shorts Commercial Music Videos. Camera geek! Local 600

Biography ICG Emerging Cinematographer Award

Bongani Mlambo is a Zimbabwean South African cinematographer based in Los Angeles obsessed with telling visually creative and compelling stories and exploring the world.

Bongani's recent projects include *All Creatures Here Below* directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (*Blade Runner 2049*, *The Dark Knight*) and Karen Gillan (*Guardians of the Galaxy*, *Jumanji*); *Three Days In August* by Johnathan Brownlee; *Upstream Color* by Shane Carruth; and *Woodshock* starring Kirsten Dunst. His work has won awards at the NBC Universal Short Film Festival, SXSW, Tellys, and numerous other festivals and he is a 2018 Film Independent Project Involve Fellow and recipient of the 2019 ICG Emerging Cinematographer Award.

Bongani got his start camera assisting on indie features, shooting short films, music videos, then eventually added commercials to his repertoire. He joined Local 600 in 2017. Beyond his artistic pursuits, Bongani loves to dance, drum, and ponder on social issues and the meaning of life. He is passionate about sharing his knowledge and talents and plans to establish arts & film workshops, programs, and residencies in Zimbabwe, inspiring and helping the next generation of Africans to tell stories pursue their dreams in the visual and performing arts.

Bongani's Emerging Cinematographer Award film, *The Coin*, follows the story of a young woman who loses a jar full of lucky coins that she has been collecting since childhood while on her journey to a new country. On Chinese New Year, finding a coin hidden inside of the dumplings means having a blessed year ahead. Her new life begins with a search to find the coin, tackling questions about identity and place of heritage in the face of forging one's own path, with an emphasis on food as a vessel for cultural traditions.

The stop motion animation film was made as part of Film Independent's Project Involve, over 6 months including approximately 32 days of photography for a runtime of 6 minutes 40 seconds. The raw stills were shot on Canon 5D and 7D. Bongani would like to thank his fellows, collaborators, mentors, the many volunteers who felted and contributed, and his family & friends.

STATEMENT OF INTEREST (Long)

Half way across the world, in the southern hemisphere, in a place just 5 percent of the population and 1/25th of the size of the U.S.A, and last on the list of countries, a little black boy was born - eyes wide open, searching, and curious.

To this day, curiosity and a quest for truth and meaning have defined my life and my art. I remember growing up a very shy, quiet, and introspective child, lost in thought and my imagination. Zimbabwe, with its culture & traditions, its colonial history and inherent residual effects, and mix of people from across the continent, with differing languages and dialects even within the tribes of Zimbabwe, created a unique environment to explore:

Memories of my twin, middle, and older sister; TV that only started at 5 p.m.; vinyl records, tapes, CDs; cartoons; backyard adventures; friends; sleepovers; Reader's Digest "Why in the World"; sadza, cerelac, freezits; Michael Jackson; WWF; pre, primary, then all-boys Catholic high school; school terms, tests, mandatory sports; large family get togethers; parents; city home, rural home; tradition; economic collapse; and the same president, now for 37 years. Somewhere along the journey, I fell in love with movies, traveled to America to study it, and for good reason. I had found my voice.

Films, movies, and art create endless opportunities for me to reflect on life, on humanity, on the universe and go on numerous journeys with different and diverse people - the ones on set with me and the imagined characters that can sometimes feel closer and more real. Sometimes it's just another day on the job, but sometimes it's an emotional experience or enlightening moment that speaks some new revelation or truth. These are the moments that I strive for.

At the heart of my interest lies cinematography - shaping the mood, feel, and look of an image, space, or environment: from the extremes of brightness and darkness, to the color or tone, to how hard or soft and diffused light appears, to the camera, the movement, the specifics of a frame, and much more. Defining a visual language for a film and evoking different emotions and psychological responses based on the story, feel very much like my own quest for truth and for knowledge. My curiosity continues.

For the special few, experiencing and creating powerful stories seems to come by nature or by some magical snap of the fingers. For the rest, creativity, talent, repetition, and toil help us get closer and closer. All the more, opportunity can catalyse and catapult you further down the road of your career than anything else.

For the past 5 years, here in America, I have camera assisted, then operated on shorts, music videos, commercials, and very quickly shoot two features in 2015 and 2016 - "All Creatures" directed by Collin Schiffli, starring David Dastmalchian (Dark Knight) and Karen Gillan (Guardians of the Galaxy, Dr. Who); and "Three Days In August" directed by Johnathan Brownlee; and had the pleasure to be involved in "Upstream Color" by Shane Carruth; and "Woodshock" starring Kirsten Dunst. I am fortunate and am grateful.

Two months ago, after being away from Zimbabwe for 12 years, I visited home. It was a surreal experience that was simultaneously reinvigorating as it was heartbreaking, seeing family, friends, and the state of my home country. If I had found my voice before, now I had found my heart and purpose. I was proud to be me, to be Zimbabwean and South African, to be African, and to be an artist & filmmaker. It inspired a sense of urgency to hone my craft, go deeper, and create work that reflects the truth and meaning I have found and still seek, and share the stories, memories, experiences, perspectives, and essence of the little black boy from Africa - through the process of cinematography & filmmaking.

Project Involve would be a great gift and honor, getting an opportunity to learn more, to grow, to collaborate, and ultimately to create in an environment that encourages and promotes an artist's uniqueness, journey, and diversity as a valuable contribution to the vast history of film.

STATEMENT OF INTEREST (500 Words)

Half way across the world, in the southern hemisphere, in a place just 5 percent of the population and 1/25th of the size of the U.S.A, and last on the list of countries, a little black boy was born - eyes wide open, searching, and curious.

To this day, curiosity and a quest for truth and meaning have defined my life and my art. I remember growing up a very shy, quiet, and introspective child, lost in thought and my imagination. Zimbabwe, with its culture & traditions, its colonial history and inherent residual effects, and mix of people from across the continent, with differing languages and dialects even within the tribes of Zimbabwe, created a unique environment to explore:

Memories of my twin, middle, and older sister; parents; TV that started at 5 p.m.; vinyl records, tapes, CDs; cartoons; backyard adventures; friends; sleepovers; Reader's Digest "Why in the World"; sadza; Michael Jackson; MTV; WWF; pre, primary, then all-boys Catholic high school; large family get togethers; city home, rural home; tradition; economic collapse; and the same president, now for 37 years. Somewhere along the journey, I fell in love with movies, traveled to America to study it, and for good reason. I had found my voice.

Films, movies, and art create endless opportunities to reflect on life, on humanity, on the universe and go on numerous journeys with different and diverse people - the ones on set with me and the imagined characters that can sometimes feel closer and more real. Sometimes it's just another day on the job, but sometimes it's an emotional experience or enlightening moment that speaks some new revelation or truth. These are the moments that I strive for.

For the special few, experiencing and creating powerful stories seems to come by nature or by some magical snap of the fingers. For the rest, creativity, talent, repetition, and toil help us get closer and closer. All the more, opportunity can catalyse and catapult you further down the road of your career than anything else.

For the past 5 years, here in America, I have camera assisted, then operated on shorts, music videos, commercials, and shot two features in 2015 and 2016, respectively. I am fortunate and am grateful. Then two months ago, after being away from Zimbabwe for 12 years, I visited home. It was a surreal experience that was simultaneously reinvigorating as it was heartbreaking, seeing family, friends, and the state of my home country. If I had found my voice before, now I had found my heart and meaning.

I was proud to be me, to be Zimbabwean and South African, to be African, and to be an artist & filmmaker. It inspired a sense of urgency to hone my craft, go deeper, and create work that reflects the truth and meaning I have found and still seek, and share the stories, memories, experiences, perspectives, and journey of the little black boy from Africa.

Project Involve would be a great gift and honor.

Pilot Mentorship Program - STATEMENT OF INTEREST - Local 600

Half way across the world, in the southern hemisphere, in a place just 5 percent of the population and 1/25th of the size of the U.S.A, and last on the list of countries, a little black boy was born - eyes wide open, searching, and curious.

To this day, curiosity and a quest for truth and meaning have defined my life and my art. I remember growing up a very shy, quiet, and introspective child, lost in thought and my imagination. Zimbabwe, with its culture & traditions, its colonial history and inherent residual effects, and mix of people from across the continent, with differing languages and dialects even within the tribes of Zimbabwe, created a unique environment to explore:

Memories of my twin, middle, and older sister; parents; TV that started at 5 p.m.; vinyl records, tapes, CDs; cartoons; backyard adventures; friends; sleepovers; Reader's Digest "Why in the World"; sadza; Michael Jackson; MTV; WWF; pre, primary, then all-boys Catholic high school; large family get togethers; city home, rural home; tradition; economic collapse; and the same president, now for 37 years. Somewhere along the journey, I fell in love with movies, traveled to America to study it, and for good reason. I had found my voice.

Films, movies, and art create endless opportunities to reflect on life, on humanity, on the universe and go on numerous journeys with different and diverse people - the ones on set with me and the imagined characters that can sometimes feel closer and more real. Sometimes it's just another day on the job, but sometimes it's an emotional experience or enlightening moment that speaks some new revelation or truth. These are the moments that I strive for.

For the special few, experiencing and creating powerful stories seems to come by nature or by some magical snap of the fingers. For the rest, creativity, talent, repetition, and toil help us get closer and closer. All the more, opportunity can catalyse and catapult you further down the road of your career than anything else. This can often come in the form of a mentor who imbues a mentee with knowledge and wisdom.

For the past 5 years, here in America, I have camera assisted, then operated on shorts, music videos, commercials, and shot two features in 2015 and 2016, respectively. I am fortunate and am grateful. Then two months ago, after being away from Zimbabwe for 12 years, I visited home. It was a surreal experience that was simultaneously reinvigorating as it was heartbreaking, seeing family, friends, and the state of my home country. If I had found my voice before, now I had found my heart and meaning.

I was proud to be me, to be Zimbabwean and South African, to be African, now U.S. citizen and to be an artist & filmmaker. It inspired a sense of urgency to hone my craft, go deeper, and create work that reflects the truth and meaning I have found and still seek, and share the stories, memories, experiences, perspectives, and journey of the little black boy from Africa. In short to add my name to the list of master artists and craftsmen of cinematography.

The Pilot Mentorship Program would be a great step in that direction and invaluable opportunity to learn and grow.

VoyageLA

Half way across the world, in the southern hemisphere, in a place just 5 percent of the population and 1/25th of the size of the U.S.A, and last on the list of countries, a little black boy was born - eyes wide open, searching, and curious.

To this day, curiosity and a quest for truth and meaning have defined my life and my art. I remember growing up a very shy, quiet, and introspective child, lost in thought and my imagination. Zimbabwe, with its culture & traditions, its colonial history and inherent residual effects, and mix of people from across the continent, with differing languages and dialects even within the tribes of Zimbabwe, created a unique environment to explore:

Memories of my twin, middle, and older sister; parents; TV that started at 5 p.m.; vinyl records, tapes, CDs; cartoons; backyard adventures; friends; sleepovers; Reader's Digest "Why in the World"; sadza; Michael Jackson; MTV; WWF; pre, primary, then all-boys Catholic high school; large family get togethers; city home, rural home; tradition; economic collapse; and the same president for 30 years. Somewhere along the journey, I fell in love with movies, traveled to America to study it, and for good reason. I had found my voice.

Films, movies, and art create endless opportunities to reflect on life, on humanity, on the universe and go on numerous journeys with different and diverse people - the ones on set with me and the imagined characters that can sometimes feel closer and more real. Sometimes it's just another day on the job, but sometimes it's an emotional experience or enlightening moment that speaks some new revelation or truth. These are the moments that I strive for.

For a special few, experiencing and creating powerful stories seems to come by nature or by some magical snap of the fingers. For the rest, creativity, talent, repetition, and toil help us get closer and closer. All the more, opportunity can catalyze and catapult you further down the road of your career than anything else and I am fortunate to have had many mentors, support from friends, colleagues, and family, and the chance of being in the right place at the right time.

In the early years, in Dallas-Fort Worth, after graduating, I camera assisted, then operated on shorts, music videos, commercials, and indie features, then eventually went on to film two features in 2015 and 2016, respectively. Then after moving to Los Angeles a few years ago, continued filming many more projects that have won awards at the NBC Universal Short Film Festival, SXSW, and numerous other festivals, and have played in theatres, museums, on Hulu and other streaming platforms. In addition, in 2018 I was a Film Independent Project Involve Fellow and then a recipient of the 2019 ICG Emerging Cinematographer Award.

While I strive to shoot many more films and projects, collaborate with many filmmakers, and reach for higher peaks, I am fortunate and grateful for how far I have come. After being away from Zimbabwe for 12 years, I visited home. It was a surreal experience that was simultaneously reinvigorating as it was heartbreaking, seeing family, friends, and the state of my home country: hopeful wonderful resilient people doing what they can to survive amidst a tyrannical government, gas and food shortages, an

economy in turmoil, and a state of disrepair. If I had found my voice before, now I had found my heart, meaning, and purpose.

As a now proud Zimbabwean South African American, artist & filmmaker, my goal is to hone my craft, go deeper, and create work that is inspirational, meaningful, authentic, and share the stories, memories, experiences, perspectives, and journey of a little black boy from Africa; to offer diverse perspectives and to promote diversity and inclusion; and to hopefully inspire and open the door for others (and others like me) to pursue filmmaking.

2023 NEH Orchestrated Letter of Commitment

I am writing this letter in support of a proposal for funding for

Letters of commitment demonstrate your partners' involvement and identify the specific contributions they will make to ensure the project's success. The content should include

- A brief description of previous collaborations with the applicant;
- The role the partner will play in the proposed project;
- The amount of monetary support they will contribute (if applicable); and
- The type and value of any in-kind support they will provide – staff time, facility space, supplies, equipment.

the program/initiative is needed, but it also outlines those things the letter writer is willing to do to make sure the project/program/initiatives happens

On behalf of XYZ Organization, I am pleased to provide this letter expressing our organization's commitment to helping your organization carry out its ABC project.

– indicates the signatory's intent to commit resources to the funded project as specified in the letter, should the proposal be funded. May also give the partner's rationale for supporting the project and point to strengths of the organization that could be of value in implementing or sustaining the project.

Description of the commitment

- writing
- cinematography
- director support
- collaboration
- people of diverse backgrounds coming together etc
- my background
- my attachment to story
- Black cinematographer (racism in film)
- Excited to capture the faces, voices, and stories, constructing a visual language that immerses the audience and can capture the spirit of...
- Rich History that is uncovered for the masses to enjoy through documentary grand piano. Alex raises his baton, holds it in a moment of long-awaited suspense, and unleashes the music that never had a chance upon us. orchestrated

Orchestrated - feature length documentary

Ignatz Waghlter's life, career, personal journey, and convictions

First African American Symphony

Alex Walker and Kyle P. Walker - lens into the classical world. New World Suite

- Negro symphony orchestra children, restoring dignity and pride in their families involvement in the greater story of America's classical movement and involvement of Black musicians.

-“It seems so simple and obvious looking out over this orchestra now, that nothing should stand in the way of these people playing this music” says Alex, ready to conduct the climactic Carnegie Hall performance of the “New World Suite.” “And yet nothing is simple or obvious when access is denied to so many,” adds Kyle, stretching his fingers to strike the keys on the

Dear National Endowment for the Humanities (NEH): I am writing to express my commitment to completing the documentary film Orchestrated. Orchestrated is a feature-length documentary that explores the complex inner workings of a symphony orchestra. Through interviews with current and former orchestra members, conductors, and orchestra administrators, the film will explore the creative, social, and economic dynamics of the symphony orchestra. I am a professional filmmaker with experience directing and producing award-winning films. My team and I have a track record of producing films on time and on budget. We are committed to producing the highest quality film possible. We are passionate about this project and are confident that the film will make a meaningful contribution to the field of music and the humanities. If awarded the NEH grant, I commit to the following: • Completing the film within the timeline and budget outlined in the grant proposal • Working with a team of experienced filmmakers and musicians • Utilizing the funds to cover all necessary production and post-production expenses • Meeting all reporting and contractual requirements as outlined by the NEH • Submitting the film for consideration to festivals and other public screenings • Providing copies

Dear National Endowment for the Humanities, I am writing to express my commitment to the project, Orchestrated, a documentary film to be directed by Natalia Iyudin. As an award-winning cinematographer and writer, I am honored to serve as the cinematographer and writer for the project. I am passionate about the project and its mission to tell the story of the joys and challenges of orchestral music. I am committed

to creating a beautiful and meaningful film that will bring the story of orchestral music to life. I am committed to working with Natalia to ensure that the film is of the highest quality and most effectively communicates the story. I am confident that this film will be an important contribution to our understanding of orchestral music. With your support, I am sure that we can create an outstanding documentary that will have a lasting impact on viewers. Thank you for considering our proposal and for your time and effort. I look forward to hearing from you. Sincerely, [Your Name]

We are committed to creating a truthful and inspiring account of this incredible chapter in music history. We are confident that our unique approach to storytelling will provide a fresh perspective on this timeless subject. We hope that our film can help to bridge the gap between past and present, and inspire a new generation of musicians and music lovers to take the stage.

I am confident that our team is the right team for the job, and I am excited to be a part of the process! I am writing this letter to confirm my commitment to the project, and my desire to work with Natalia, Katarzyna and the rest of the team to create a film that will be both informative and entertaining. I am very passionate about the project and look forward to being a part of this exciting venture.

Our film aims to tell this remarkable story, while examining the racism that continues to haunt classical music today. We believe that this project is an important contribution to the humanities, and we are asking for your financial support to help us bring this story to life on the big screen. We thank you for your consideration and look forward to hearing from you. Sincerely,

Write a letter of commitment for an NEH grant proposal for a documentary film called Orchestrated.

The film follows an unlikely partnership between Harlem Renaissance leaders and Ignatz Waghalter—a Polish-Jewish conductor and composer who made an international career in Berlin and fled to New York City during Hitler's rise to power—to establish the first standing African American symphony orchestra. Alex Walker, a British conductor with a dry wit and a fervor for forgotten composers—and Kyle P. Walker, an emerging Black pianist, podcaster and BLM activist with an unflinching sense of purpose, take us inside this remarkable story, while examining the racism that continues to haunt classical music today.

I am a cinematographer based in Los Angeles, California who grew up in Harare, Zimbabwe, an introspective child whose imagination blossomed into a curiosity and quest for truth and meaning that have defined my life and art. As an artist & filmmaker, my goal is to hone my craft, go deeper, and create work that is inspirational, meaningful, authentic, and share the stories, memories, experiences, perspectives, and journey of a little black boy from Africa; to offer diverse perspectives and to promote diversity and inclusion; and to hopefully inspire and open the door for others (and others like me) to pursue filmmaking.

I am excited to capture the faces, voices, and stories that will bring the film to life. Using my years of experience and artistic sensibilities to construct a visual language that immerses the audience and can capture the spirit of collaboration, perseverance, and humanity at the center of our story. I am the cinematographer and writer on the film.

What convinced me to join the team was the quality of the evidence that Perzanowska and Alex Walker were assembling about Waghalter and the Negro Symphony Orchestra from family archives, press reports, and other historical documents available at the Schomburg Center and elsewhere. What's convinced me to sEck with it is the even more remarkable material that we've discovered in the past year from the James Weldon Johnson CollecEon at the Beinecke Library at Yale, and the personal contacts that we are currently making with descendants of the orchestra members.

Natalia Iyudin will direct the film.

From Natalia's first mention of the film, I have been intrigued with not only its subject matter — but I have also been incredibly impressed with the way she and her co-producer, Katarzyna Glowacka, have approached developing the project into what you see in their application. They took a fascinating subject and imbued it with rich story-driven, character-driven essence, resulting in what I believe will be historical film that I truly feel will make the humanities accessible to a wide audience.

We have built an amazing team — not just on the humanities/academic side, but on the film side as well. Our “cast” of interview subjects will be so compelling.

Made in Her Image Volunteer

I am a Zimbabwean South African DP based in LA and much of childhood and teens did not have any examples, initiatives, people, or possibilities that pointed to a career in film, so I came to film school in the US and now live here pursuing a career in Hollywood. Often, the stories you hear of how people got started include some moment when you see some in the film industry working, a person with a camera, or have a model of possible jobs. Growing up in Zimbabwe, that did not exist. Even here, for some kids growing up, the situation may be the same, so I would love to be able to contribute to expanding the options they have and also helping them be fulfilled through using their creativity and learning.

My day job is cinematography for the last 5 years and before that, assisting and operating since 2010 when I graduated film school. Have worked on passion projects to large union shoots, so understand being resourceful and simplifying concepts, gear, and techniques. My website for reference: bongaj.com

In addition, I have often guest lectured a few classes for students about to graduate from my alma mater, having conversations about the joys, challenges, and realities of industry and my experience. Sometimes this includes breaking down and explaining specifics about cinematography, budgeting, producing, and other topics using presentations, examples, and videos.

In general, most of my experience volunteering has been with peers and people +/- 5 to 10 years around my own age. I volunteered and was a leader in Youth group growing up, then was involved in multiple groups and organizations in college. More recently, my experience with youth in the 8-18 year old age range is through my cousins and nieces, some of whom are interested in filmmaking and I mentor one on one. I love breaking down things to their core pieces and explaining, especially in a hands on setting or interactive format.

Sporas

Films, movies, and art create endless opportunities to reflect on life, on humanity, on the universe and go on numerous journeys with different and diverse people - the ones on set with me and the imagined characters that can sometimes feel closer and more real. Sometimes it's just another day on the job, but sometimes it's an emotional experience or enlightening moment that speaks some new revelation or truth. These are the moments that I strive for.

Tips from Daniel

STATEMENT

Personal History

Why you do what you do

Get them interested and get on your team.

Someone open to learn and help.

BIOGRAPHY

300-500 words. Business oriented. Why you are different where you are from.

Talk about your credits. Very introductory. I am and have worked on... Three credits

Embrace your uniqueness

"Project Involve is a free, intensive, nine-month annual program that offers 30 up-and-coming film professionals from under-represented communities the opportunity to hone skills, form creative partnerships, utilize free or low-cost production resources and ultimately gain the industry access necessary to succeed as working artists. "

"Society is enriched when the stories told on film reflect the distinct vision of independent artists from every facet of our multi-cultural community"

Bongani Thoughts

Begin with a hook - personal anecdote that relates to your career path. Or a unique perspective on your art.

Personal History, Who You Are
12 years not home. Perspective

Why, Why you do what you do, Purpose
What are you doing. What does your art express. What emotions. What ideas.

Art, Learning, Film is Life, Film, Cinematography. Light. Truth. Exploring. Experimenting Creatively
Meaningful exploration of ideas. Unconventional

Why cinematography. Process and how you do it. What your art does for you.
Being Creative. Urgency to create. What or Who Inspires you?
Focus, skilled, enthusiastic

Underrepresented. "up-and-coming film professionals from under-represented communities"
"Society is enriched when the stories told on film reflect the distinct vision of independent artists from every facet of our multi-cultural community"
The sadness around it. Discrimination.

Africa and Art. Break through the ceiling. Love to represent. Reinspired.

Uniqueness, Interesting background. Someone open to learn and help.

What I wonder about - Story, Life, Truth, Knowledge, Existentialism, Philosophy of filmmaking, concepts, theories, frameworks.

What you want to do and accomplish. Get them interested and on your team.
Drive to be the best. Connect. Learn. Grow. Abstract concepts and things.

Experience. Goals. Motivation. Mention work you have done. Optimizing and improving things, including myself.

Career is a journey not a destination. As you gain experience you become more capable to function creatively, and enjoy freedom, ingenuity, and innovation. With the right collaborators.

Honor to be a part.

When light hits in just the right way, for me, there is an overwhelming sense of awe and appreciation. My curious investigative mind that wants to break it down and figure it out is silenced and there is a sense of just letting the light shine. More often than not, it happens most in nature - a beautiful sunset or sky, reflected sunlight off of shiny objects that creates mesmerizing patterns, or great ominous shafts that pierce through darkness. It is strange the ways we can react to light.

Movies, specifically, I consider a unique art form that incorporates the best of multiple disciplines, crafts, and talents to create an immersive experience and story. The feat of creating memorable ones is challenging and working on great projects can inspire.